

Adult Guide - E01 Something Is Here

Review version 1.1.0 Author: Maria Smith Audience: parents, carers, early-years practitioners and teachers Final-publication status: awaiting Maria Smith's approval

Purpose of the new game-story edition

The child joins Mira and Pip in a five-clue “Nothing Hunt.” Each challenge page lets the child look, listen, choose, point or communicate before the following page reveals and discusses possible answers. The story delays its general rule until the child has experienced empty, quiet, blank, hidden and unrepresented cases.

The child book deliberately avoids the formal terms candidate grammar, counterexample, occurrence, operational boundary and direct forcing. Those exact terms belong here, where an adult can protect the scientific scope without making the child repeat unexplained language.

Exact SFT source

Claim: SFT-ROOT-THERE-IS-NO-NOTHING Status: independently replicated Provenance: direct forcing Closure: depth-independent within the declared operational boundary Receipt: sha256: 711864171e4d3a2f2734f0c2890965bcd81a0228349538751a3c80699c27d669

Exact statement:

No admissible operational statement, denial, record, proof object or
derivational object is nothing: absence presents no counterexample, while
every presented counterexample is an occurrence.

The complete declared grammar has two named classes:

1. Unpresented absence supplies no statement, denial, record, trace or

identity, so it supplies no operational counterexample.

1. Presented occurrence supplies a statement, denial, record, trace or

identity; that presentation is an occurrence and is not nothing.

The theorem does not claim knowledge of an unexpressed metaphysical domain. The book's game, characters and visible examples are educational translations; they do not prove a new theorem or replace the admitted claim package.

Learning through experience

After repeated shared play, a child may begin to:

- notice several things in a detailed scene;
- distinguish a present container from a named item that is not inside it;
- distinguish a missing sound or mark from the listening or page that remains;
- notice that hidden is not the same as erased;

- attempt a challenge before seeing a possible answer;
- sort presented examples from a case where no example is supplied;
- explain a choice by pointing, speaking, signing, drawing or using a

communication aid; and

- keep an unexpected answer rather than changing the game to force agreement.

These are invitations, not pass/fail expectations.

Child-facing vocabulary

- here - available in the game for us to notice;
- inside - held within the named container;
- empty - the named content is not inside a container;
- still - no declared movement happened during the short check;
- blank - no declared mark appears on the card;
- hidden - blocked from the chosen view;
- clue - something noticed that helps the investigation;
- check - look, listen or try again using the declared game; and
- example - something supplied for the players to inspect.

Prefer those words in conversation. If a child asks about “occurrence” or “boundary,” explain them in ordinary language but do not require recall.

Before playing

The printed story is complete without extra materials. Optional demonstration materials are:

- one large, safe open box or bowl;
- one familiar large toy;
- a bell that an adult controls, or simply a pretend bell;
- sturdy paper and thick crayons; and
- a blanket or cloth used where the child can see and leave freely.

Avoid small parts, sealed containers, blindfolds and enforced silence. Never hide a person, essential comfort object or item the child may find distressing. The child may watch, point, sign, speak, move, draw or opt out.

How to use a challenge/reveal pair

1. Read the challenge page and pause.
2. Let the child scan the whole illustration before prompting.
3. Accept any clearly identified present detail, including one not in the

suggested answer.

1. Ask “What helped you decide?” rather than “Are you sure?”

2. Turn the page and compare with the reveal.
3. If the child's answer differs, keep it and inspect the picture together.

The reveal is a shared check, not a score screen. Several pages contain extra details so noticing beyond the printed target remains valuable.

Page-by-page story and answer guidance

Pages 3-4 - enter the Nothing Hunt

Invite the child to trace the route on the map and count the empty star spaces by pointing, without turning this into a number lesson. Rehearse the game rhythm: "Spot, say, then check." A non-speaking child may use gaze, gesture or a partner record.

Pages 5-6 - warm-up spot scene

The five illustrated answers are Mira, Pip, the box, bell and rug. The lamp, question card and peeking star are valid extra answers. The aim is to establish that the child can find more than the adult's printed list.

Pages 7-9 - the empty box

Challenge first: "Did she find nothing?" Do not correct immediately.

Reveal: the named toy is not inside. The box, its lid, looking and the players remain presented. Page 9 gives the child-facing distinction: empty says what is missing from a named container; it does not erase the container.

Optional demonstration: show the large toy, place it in the box, remove it and ask what changed and what stayed. Keep both records.

Pages 10-11 - the still bell

Allow a brief listening pause. Expected observations include Mira listening, Pip waiting and the bell staying still. "No ring" is bounded to that short declared moment. If a real sound interrupts an optional demonstration, record it rather than replaying solely to obtain the desired answer.

Do not describe silence as a substance and do not ask the child to remain still.

Pages 12-13 - the blank card

The four intended clues are the card, its edge, Pip's feather and Mira's magnifying glass. Other page features may also be noticed. The reveal separates "no mark on the card" from "no card presented."

Pages 14-15 - the hidden word

The letters N-O-T-H-I-N-G appear across seven blocks. A child may find some letters, the whole word, other shapes or the enclosing outline. The reveal shows that a written label is itself a presented record. It is not automatically the thing it names.

Pages 16-17 - behind the curtain

The toys are hidden from the chosen view. The curtain, its toy-shaped bumps, Mira, Pip and play remain visible. Avoid generalising this to objects that are unobserved by every route; the activity concerns one blocked view in the scene.

Pages 18-21 - the two-door game

Page 19 is the setup. Door A presents a star card while saying it has presented “nothing.” Door B supplies no example.

Page 20 checks Door A: the handover, card and inspection are presented, so the offered example is an occurrence rather than nothing.

Page 21 checks Door B: there is no delivered example to inspect. This is not a secret counterexample and the book must not pretend one was supplied.

These two doors are the child-facing translation of the complete two-class candidate grammar. The picture game does not replace its formal census.

Pages 22-23 - try to draw nothing

Both choices are allowed. If the child draws, the mark and action are presented. If the child makes no mark, the card and the choice remain presented. Do not call a blank page numerical zero.

Pages 24-25 - infer and name the result

Only after all challenges does Mira state the detective rule. Ask the child to retell one earlier level that supports it. Page 25 then names the root theorem: “There is no nothing.” The adult should retain the operational boundary in the exact-source section above.

Page 26 - fair-play boundary

The game mat marks what can be shown, said, drawn or recorded. Beyond the rope, the illustration adds no invented object and makes no claim. A useful adult sentence is: “We say what our check can reach, and we do not pretend it reaches farther.”

Pages 27-28 - final spot scene

The four intended pairs are:

- box here - no toy inside;
- bell here - no ring during the scene;
- card here - no mark on the card; and
- curtain here - toy hidden from the chosen view.

Mira, Pip and decorative shapes are valid extra present details.

Pages 29-30 - sorting game

Place the empty box, still bell and blank card under “something to check.” Each is a presented object with a declared missing content, event or mark. Place only the dashed “no example given” card under that heading. The second basket does not contain a hidden thing; it records that no example was supplied.

Pages 31-32 - retell and continue

The certificate records participation, not attainment. Invite the child to choose one clue to retell. Page 32 previews E02 by showing one whole made from visible fitting parts; it does not yet teach the next theorem.

Common misconceptions and gentle responses

“An empty box is nothing.”

“The toy is not inside. What can you point to that is still here?”

“Nothing happened when the bell did not ring.”

“You noticed no ring. What did you do while you checked?”

“If I cannot see it, it is nothing.”

“In this picture the curtain blocks one view. What else can we still see?”

“The word NOTHING is nothing.”

“Can you point to the letters? Then the written word is something we can check.”

“Door B proves a secret nothing is behind it.”

“Door B did not give us an example. We do not add a secret one.”

“The theorem tells us everything about what nobody could ever express.”

It does not. The admitted claim concerns operational statements, denials, records, proof objects and derivational objects. It claims no knowledge of an unexpressed metaphysical domain.

Observation notes

Use brief narrative notes only when useful. Possible observations include:

- scans a complex illustration and notices an unprompted detail;
- waits for the reveal after offering an answer;
- distinguishes container from named content;
- distinguishes no event from listening or waiting;
- explains that hidden depends on a selected view;
- accepts or investigates a different answer; and
- communicates through speech, sign, gaze, pointing, drawing or an aid.

Accessibility

- Read all text and illustration descriptions aloud when helpful.
- Offer real, large tactile versions of the box, card and cloth.
- Every target has a shape or text cue; colour is never the only cue.
- Let the child examine one area at a time or cover busy parts of a scene.
- Accept all communication routes and allow extra processing time.
- Use the semantic HTML edition for scalable text and page descriptions.
- The PDF contains selectable text but is not claimed as a fully tagged PDF.

Reference-only curriculum navigation

The play can support attention, turn-taking, communication, early literacy, observation and expressive response. Those usability links are calibrated against Early Years practice. Curricula are not scientific dependencies and do not validate the theorem.

Scientific checks preserved in the adult edition

The admitted claim passed the complete two-class census, minimality, named-shape uniqueness, false-premise, tampered-source, tampered-artifact and boundary controls, plus implementation-distinct reconstruction. The story translates these habits into paired challenges, both two-door routes, a delayed reveal and a fair-play boundary.

No empirical claim is added. The box, bell, card, curtain and game characters are demonstrations of language and checking, not measurements proving the formal theorem.

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